

Subtraction

A NUMBER IS SUBTRACTED FROM ANOTHER NUMBER TO FIND WHAT IS LEFT. THIS IS KNOWN AS THE DIFFERENCE.

SEE ALSO

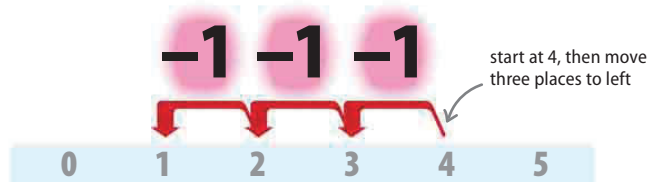
◀ 16 Addition

Positive and negative numbers

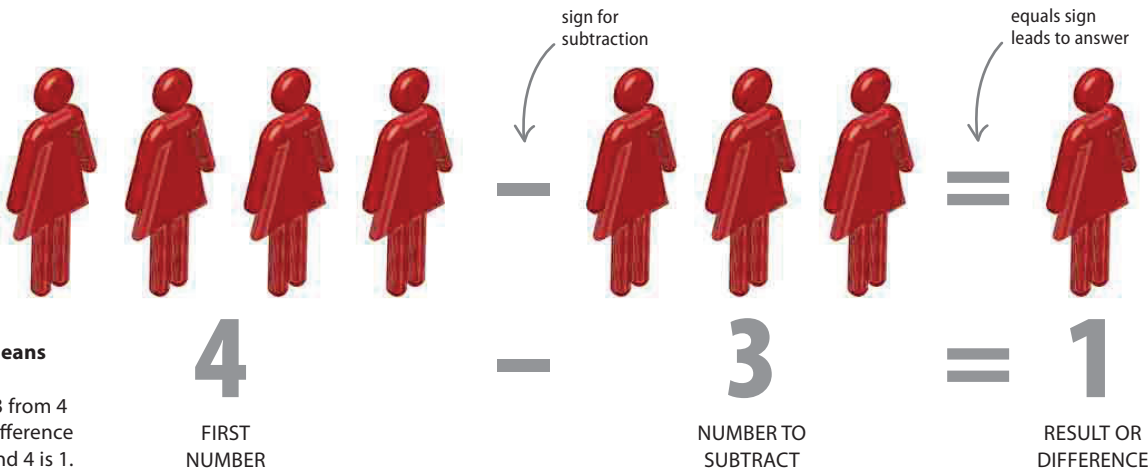
34–35 ▶

Taking away

A number line can also be used to show how to subtract numbers. From the first number, move back along the line the number of places shown by the second number. Here 3 is taken from 4.



◁ **Use a number line**
To subtract 3 from 4, start at 4 and move three places along the number line, first to 3, then 2, and then to 1.

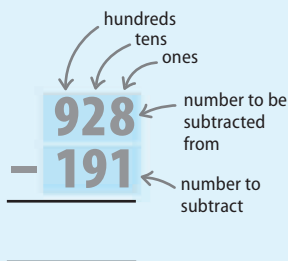


▷ What it means

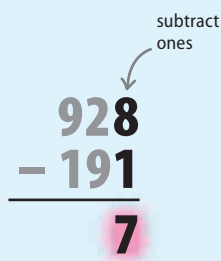
The result of subtracting 3 from 4 is 1, so the difference between 3 and 4 is 1.

Subtracting large numbers

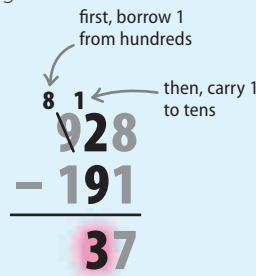
Subtracting numbers of two or more digits is done in vertical columns. First subtract the ones, then the tens, the hundreds, and so on. Sometimes a digit is borrowed from the next column along.



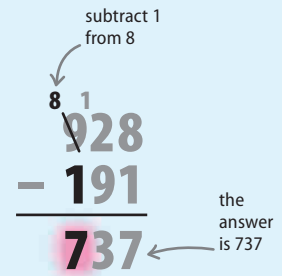
First, the numbers are written with their ones, tens, and hundreds directly above each other.



Next, subtract the unit 1 from 8, and write their difference of 7 in the space underneath them.



In the tens, 9 cannot be subtracted from 2, so 1 is borrowed from the hundreds, turning 9 into 8 and 2 into 12.



In the hundreds column, 1 is subtracted from the new, now lower number of 8.